A-A-2479
August 15, 1988

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

PLIERS, (NONSPARKING AND NONMAGNETIC)

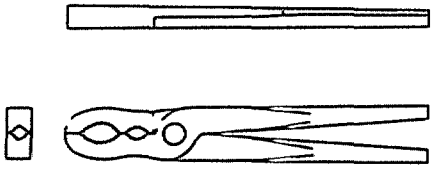
The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description.

This commercial item description covers three types of pliers made of a nonferrous alloy having a low sparking hazard and a low magnetic permeability.

Salient characteristics:

Types. The pliers shall be of conventional design furnished in the following types and sizes (overall length) as specified by National Stock Number (NSN):

Type I pliers shall be of the type known as gas pliers similar to the following illustration and have an overall length of 8 inches, plus or minus 1/2 inch (NSN 5120-00-203-8370). The jaws of the pliers shall be of uniform width and the outer end or nose shall be rounded. The pliers shall have a central longitudinal grip at the outer end of the jaw and shall have two different size transverse grips of elliptical shape in the jaw body. With the outermost ends of the jaws opened not more than 3/32 of an inch, the smaller transverse grip shall securely hold a 1/4 inch diameter rod and the larger grip shall securely hold a 3/8 inch diameter rod. The larger transverse grip shall have a capacity for holding a rod at least 1-1/4 inches in diameter. The gripping surfaces shall have sharp pointed teeth. The front end of the pliers in conjunction with the longitudinal grip shall be suitable for gripping both flat and round objects.



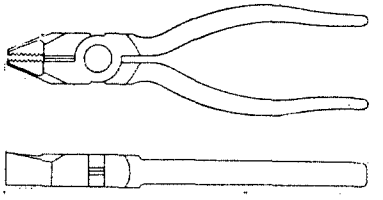
Type I, gas, noncutting.

Type II pliers shall be of the linesman's, side cutting type similar to the following illustration, and have an overall length of 8-1/2 inches, plus or minus 1/2 inch (NSN 5120-00-224-1540). The jaws shall have cutting edges on one side near the joint end. The cutting edges shall extend approximately one half of the length of the jaws. The remaining portion of the jaws shall have straight surfaces, scored with a straight or uniform diamond-shaped pattern. With the pliers in a closed position, the cutting edges shall contact each other throughout the entire length. There shall be a recess in the jaws behind the side cutters to provide satisfactory cutting clearance. The handles at the joint end shall be suitable for crushing wire insulation. With the pliers closed, the ends of the jaws shall not touch, but shall have a clearance which will permit firmly gripping a 0.040-inch diameter wire.

FSC 5120

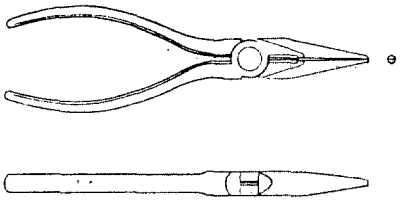
DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:23Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.



Type II, lineman's, side cutting.

Type III pliers shall be the long round nose (chain), side cutting type similar to the following illustration, and have an overall length of 6-1/2 inches, plus or minus 1/2 inch (NSN 5120-00-541-6732). The jaws shall be suitable for forming wire loops, handling small objects and reaching into small openings. Each jaw shall be of half round cross section so that the gripping surfaces are plane and straight. The jaws shall taper uniformly from near the joint section to the outermost end. One-fourth to one-third of the gripping surfaces of the jaw from the outermost end shall be scored. The jaws shall be provided with cutting edges on one side near the joint end. The cutting edges shall extend approximately one-fourth the length of the jaws. There shall be a recess behind the cutter to provide clearance for the cutting edges.



Type III, long round nose (chain), side cutting.

Material. Material shall be a beryllium copper or aluminum bronze alloy having an iron content not over five percent, and when present, it shall be well diffused throughout the alloy. When tested with a magnetic permeability indicator conforming to Military Specification MIL-I-17214, the magnetic permeability shall not be above 1.2 on the indicator scale.

Surface finish. Surfaces shall be finished in accordance with good commercial practice and shall be free from fins, scale, cracks, seams, burrs, or any other defects which may affect the serviceability or durability of the pliers. Forging flash lines shall be removed sufficiently to blend smoothly with adjacent surfaces.

Heat treatment. Types II and III pliers shall have a cutting edge hardness of Rockwell C16, or equivalent, minimum.

Handles. The handles shall be of a size and shape to provide a comfortable grip and be capable of withstanding normal handle loads without distortion or permanent set which would render the pliers unserviceable.

Joints. The pliers shall have a flush ground countersunk rivet joint properly tensioned to retain alignment of the plier halves, but sufficiently loose to allow one-hand operation of the pliers.

Marking. Pliers shall be marked in a plain and permanent manner with name, abbreviation, or chemical symbol of the alloy, the manufacturer's name or trademark of such known character that the source of manufacture may be readily determined, and the country of origin.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:23Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Workmanship. Pliers shall be free from any defect that impairs durability, serviceability, and appearance.

Quality assurance provisions. Sampling for inspection shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105, Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes, except where otherwise indicated herein. The lot size shall consist of all plierss offered for acceptance at one time. A sample unit shall be one plier.

A. Examination for design, dimensions and workmanship. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an acceptable quality level (AQL) of 4.0 percent defective.

B. Material. Material shall be ascertained by manufacturer's certification.

C. Hardness testing. Hardness testing shall be in conformance with commercially accepted procedures. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 percent defective.

Regulatory requirements. In accordance with the section 23.403 of the Federal Acquisition Regulations, the Government's policy is to acquire items composed of the highest percentage of recovered materials practicable, consistent with maintaining a satisfactory level of competition without adversely affecting performance requirements or exposing suppliers' employees to undue hazards from the recovered materials.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. The preservation, packaging packing, labeling, and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order.

Notes:

The issue of referencedd documents in effect on the date of invitation for bid or request for proposals shall be used to determine compliance with the stated requirements. Sources for obtaining referenced documents may be determined by contacting the Contracting Officer.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

NONE: DOD has determined that no military activity has an official interest in this commercial item description.

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

GSA-FSS

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:23Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.